In the book *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill presents evidence suggesting Dr. Louis Jolyon "Jolly" West had ties to the CIA's MKUltra program and was proximal to Charles Manson. O'Neill's research indicates West worked with Sidney Gottlieb to design foundational MKUltra experiments and boasted about implanting false memories. O'Neill also suggests West maintained an office at the Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic, while Manson frequented the facility and ran a clandestine lab disguised as a hippie commune in the same area. Learn more about the book "Chaos" at Los Angeles Review of Books.

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill identifies the clandestine lab as a **dilapidated Victorian house** or apartment located in **San Francisco's Haight-Ashbury district**, less than a mile from Charles Manson's residence.

- **The Location:** Dr. Louis Jolyon "Jolly" West rented this property during the 1966–1967 academic year to serve as a "fake hippie crash pad." It functioned as a semi-permanent observation post that allowed researchers to study the hippie culture "in their native habitat."
- **The "Lab" Activity:** West described the house as a **"laboratory disguised as a hippie crash pad"** where he and his team could recruit and observe youth using LSD. According to O'Neill's findings in the Los Angeles Review of Books, West also maintained a professional office at the Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic to recruit subjects for these studies.
- **Manson's Proximity:** During this same period, Charles Manson and members of his "Family" were regular visitors to the clinic and lived in the immediate vicinity, placing them in direct contact with the environment West was monitoring.

Should we look into the **specific funding sources** O'Neill found that linked this "crash pad" to **CIA-backed foundations**?

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill traces the funding for Dr. Louis Jolyon "Jolly" West's San Francisco operations to several organizations that served as "conduits" for CIA money.
Key CIA-Backed Funding Sources O'Neill identifies the following entities as critical links between West's research and the government's clandestine mind-control programs:

- **The Human Ecology Fund:** Originally called the Society for the Investigation of Human Ecology, this was a prominent CIA front organization. It was established specifically to disguise the agency's financial support for behavioral research from the public and even from some of the researchers themselves.
- **The Geschickter Fund for Medical Research:** O'Neill highlights this as another known conduit used by the CIA's MKUltra program to funnel money to academic researchers.
- **Air Force and Military Grants:** West also received funding through military channels, including as a U.S. Air Force medical director, which supported his earlier studies into "brainwashing" techniques used on POWs during the Korean War.

The Funding Strategy
O'Neill argues that these funds enabled West to operate in the Haight-Ashbury district with a dual purpose:

1. **Recruitment:** West used his professional presence at the Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic to identify and recruit "unwitting subjects" for studies on LSD and amphetamines.
2. **Observation:** The CIA-backed funding allowed him to maintain the **"hippie crash pad"** (the clandestine lab), where he could observe the youth counterculture "in their native habitat" while testing behavioral modification theories.

O'Neill notes that while Manson's parole officer, Roger Smith, was also conducting amphetamine research at the clinic, documentation suggests both he and the clinic's founder were bankrolled by government-linked sources during the same period Manson was a regular fixture at the facility.
Would you like to know more about the **specific experiments** O'Neill uncovered in West's papers, such as the **"implanting of false memories"**?

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill digs through Dr. Jolly West's private archives at UCLA and uncovering disturbing details about his obsession with "reprogramming" the human mind. West was not just observing behavior; he was actively looking for ways to replace a person's identity with a new one.

1. **False Memory & Suggestibility:**
West's work for the CIA centered on the idea that under the right conditions—specifically sleep deprivation, isolation, and drugs—the human mind becomes a "blank slate."

- **The Technique:** West experimented with **"environmental manipulation"** to make subjects hyper-suggestible.
- **The Goal:** He claimed he could use these states to implant memories of events that never happened. In his papers, O'Neill found West boasting that he could convince a person they had committed a crime or witnessed an event, a technique he called **"DDD" (Debility, Dependency, and Dread)**.
- **The Manson Link:** O'Neill points out that Manson used these exact same "DDD" pillars—starving his followers (debility), making them rely on him for food and sex (dependency), and preaching about a coming race war (dread)—to control the Family.

2. **"Total Controlled Environments":**
West was fascinated by how a leader could maintain absolute authority over a group.

- **The Lab Experiment:** At his Haight-Ashbury "crash pad," West sought to create a **micro-society**. He wanted to see if he could take "alienated" youth and, through the supervised use of LSD, reshape their social values.
- **The Replacement of Values:** West's notes suggest he was looking for ways to "unfreeze" a person's old morals and "refreeze" them with new ones. This mirrors how Manson convinced middle-class kids that killing was a "beautiful" act of liberation.

3. **The Jack Ruby Connection:**
O'Neill uses West's previous "successes" to show he was a master of psychological manipulation.

- **The Evaluation:** In 1964, West was the psychiatrist who examined **Jack Ruby** (the man who killed Lee Harvey Oswald).
- **The Result:** After West spent time alone with Ruby, the prisoner—who had previously been lucid—suddenly suffered a psychotic break, claiming he heard voices and that Jews were being slaughtered in the basement.
- **O'Neill's Suspicion:** O'Neill suggests West may have used his techniques to **induce madness** in Ruby to prevent him from testifying, demonstrating that West had the "field experience" to break a human mind.

4. **Direct Experiments at the Clinic:**
While Manson was at the Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic, West and Manson's parole officer, Roger Smith, were studying **"violent behavior and drugs."**

- They were specifically looking at how **amphetamines** (which Manson and his followers used heavily) could be used to trigger paranoid or aggressive states.
- O'Neill highlights the coincidence that Manson, a man with a low IQ and a history of failed leadership, suddenly emerged from this specific medical environment in 1967 as a "sophisticated" guru with advanced brainwashing techniques.

Would you like me to detail the **suspicious behavior of Manson's parole officer**, Roger Smith, and how he allegedly "protected" Manson from being sent back to prison?

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill portrays **Roger Smith** not as a negligent officer, but as a deliberate "guardian angel" who repeatedly intervened to keep Manson on the streets despite clear grounds for re-arrest.

1. **Unprecedented Leniency:**
Manson was on federal parole after a decade in prison and violated the terms almost immediately upon arriving in San Francisco in 1967.

- **The Violations:** Manson engaged in drug use, pimping, and moving across state lines without permission. Standard procedure dictated an immediate return to prison.
- **The Protection:** Smith consistently filed reports claiming Manson was "making progress" or "adjusting well," even when Manson was under investigation for crimes. O'Neill found that Smith frequently blocked local police from arresting Manson, claiming he was a "special case" under his supervision.

2. **The Research Partnership:**
The relationship between the two was more than professional; it was academic. Smith was a doctoral student at UC Berkeley and a lead researcher at the **Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic**.

- **Manson as a Subject:** Smith's thesis focused on **"The Amphetamine Subculture."** O'Neill suggests Manson was not just a parolee, but also a primary research subject.
- **The Clinic Link:** Smith shared an office space at the clinic with **Dr. Jolly West**. O'Neill emphasizes that while Smith was "studying" Manson's ability to lead a group of drug-using youth, the CIA-funded West was studying how to create "total controlled environments" in that exact same building.

3. **The "Get Out of Jail Free" Card:**
O'Neill details a specific instance where Manson was arrested in a stolen car with several young girls.

- Instead of letting the law take its course, Smith personally intervened with the judge and the DA to have the charges dropped.
- **The Timing:** This protection continued right up until the Family moved to Los Angeles, effectively "escorting" the group toward the site of the eventual murders.

4. **Post-Murder Silence:**
After the Tate-LaBianca murders, Roger Smith largely disappeared from the public record regarding Manson. O'Neill notes that Smith refused to be interviewed for decades. When O'Neill finally tracked him down, Smith's explanations for his leniency remained vague, fueling O'Neill's theory that Smith was either a "handler" or was instructed by higher authorities—potentially linked to **Operation CHAOS**—to keep Manson in the "field." According to the Los Angeles Review of Books, O'Neill's findings suggest that if Roger Smith had simply done his job, the "Family" would have been dismantled years before the murders occurred.

Do you want to see the **specific timeline** of Manson's arrests and Smith's interventions during the "Summer of Love"?